

UCLA ANDERSON

INSIDER TIPS



ABOUT ANDERSON

UCLA Anderson defines its community by three core qualities: share success, think fearlessly and drive change. It's lauded for pioneering the nation's first field-study program nearly 50 years ago—the Applied Management Research Program—and establishing the Easton Technology Management Center. Anderson's motto, "Think in the Next," speaks to a penchant for bold thinkers who are unafraid to chart new pathways and effect change.

The incoming class of 360 MBA candidates is nested within a powerhouse university of more than 40,000 students, located in one of the most diverse cities in the U.S. As the world's 15th largest economy, LA is home to more than 300,000 small businesses, and its vibrant tech scene produces four times the GDP of Silicon Valley. Its reputation as a creative city in media and entertainment are unparalleled, but LA's strengths extend to sectors such as consulting, finance, health care and consumer products. This nexus of industry, creativity and business-creation offers noteworthy access to company visits, guest speakers, mentors and internships.

Anderson has a nine-course core curriculum includes the option to add a specialization for a deeper dive into a target industry or function. The second year of study is entirely by individual design, allowing students to choose from an array of electives. Students also complete an Applied Management Research project (AMR), a two-quarter capstone experience that synthesizes classroom learning and applies it in a real-world business setting.

STRENGTHS & SPECIALIZATIONS

Entrepreneurship, finance, tech, communications and
entertainment

KEY STATS

MBA RANKINGS*	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019
BusinessWeek	18	-	11	13	-	19	17	12
Financial Times	15	13	14	14	-	15	14	14
Forbes	-	13	-	17	-	15	-	16
The Economist	15	12	11	7	-	6	7	5
US News	15	14	16	15	-	15	16	16

CLASS OF 2021 ADMISSIONS

Number of Applicants	2817	Avg Age	28
MBA Class Size	360	Avg GMAT	719
Admissions selectivity	26%	Avg GPA	3.5
Yield	49.15%	% International	33%
Total Tuition	US\$130,228	% Women	34%

POST-MBA CAREERS (CLASS OF 2019)

Technology	29.5%
Consulting	20.4%
Finance	14.9%
Consumer Products	7.6%

TOP RECRUITERS INCLUDE:

Adobe, Amazon, American Airlines, Deloitte, Merrill Lynch, Microsoft, Netflix

AVERAGE BASE SALARY: **US\$121,843**

EMPLOYED IN 3 MONTHS: **90%**



TOP TIPS FOR ACING YOUR UCLA ANDERSON APPLICATION

BY JESSICA CHUNG

Jessica joined Fortuna after a decade of experience with UCLA Anderson. Serving as Associate Director of Admissions, she evaluated and interviewed thousands of applications for the full-time MBA program. She also managed the program's global recruiting and admit events, advised on fellowship decisions for admitted students and collaborated on strategic projects.



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1

KNOW ANDERSON'S PRINCIPLES

A few years back, the school defined its driving principles - Share Success, Think Fearlessly, Drive Change - which adcoms use as a filter for assessing each candidate. The website has some good examples with specific student, alumni and faculty stories illuminating these principles in action. This year's singular essay question challenges you to reflect deeply on how the events of the past year influenced the impact you would like to make in your community, career, or both. There is a lot of opportunity to exemplify one or more of those qualities as you consider your response.

GET TO KNOW THE COMMUNITY

2

Adcoms expect candidates to go beyond surface level research when getting to know Anderson and the community. While you can typically meet school reps at events throughout the year (most events now moved to a virtual format in light of the pandemic), making an effort to forge deeper connections with students and alumni - especially those with similar backgrounds/goals - using their stories to support your candidacy is especially compelling. If you can't attend an in-person event, emailing officers of student clubs is another great way to learn more about careers/recruiting. Take advantage of these pathways to build relationships with students and learn their stories. Covid conditions permitting, we highly recommend a visit to campus.

3

UNDERSTAND THE CULTURE

Piggybacking on the previous point, strong cultural fit is an extremely important aspect of the evaluation process. Anderson prides itself on being very supportive and looks for individuals who are driven but not cutthroat competitive. Through the application and interview, the admissions team scours the pool for individuals with these qualities - being highly collaborative but with a sense of humbleness and openness to feedback. There's a strong entrepreneurial spirit in the program as well, so showing this mindset (not necessarily being an entrepreneur, but demonstrating innovative thinking within your company) is crucial.

INVOLVEMENT IS CRUCIAL

4

Anderson has a rich tradition of active involvement outside the classroom, and the school highly encourages creating new clubs or events as needs of the student community evolves. Most activities on campus are student driven or led, and it's a big priority to craft a class that will uphold this legacy each year. History of involvement in extracurriculars, volunteer work, etc., is important beyond a superficial level, so you should demonstrate true passion and dedication to the causes and communities to which you belong. If you don't have a robust extracurricular profile and want to beef it up in the time before submitting applications, I suggest looking for roles that go beyond being a mere "member" and make a substantive contribution - organize an event, revamp an organization's social media strategy, analyze ROI on events and suggest improvements, etc.

5

EMPHASIZE LOCATION

Candidates should be familiar with LA/SoCal/CA's vibrant business culture, diversity, and pioneering spirit, and connect it back to their goals and/or "why Anderson." What really frustrates adcoms are applicants who apply with a very stereotyped mindset about Anderson - e.g. it's only for anyone interested in entertainment, there aren't many opportunities in finance/consulting, it's a "regional" school and you can't get a job outside of CA, etc. Understanding the benefits of the school's strategic LA location, and not falling (even unconsciously) into stereotypes or biases (such as "LA is more laid back than east coast cities") will signal that you're a serious candidate. Be familiar with LA's strengths - e.g., virtually every major company is headquartered or has an office in Southern CA, LA is the world's 16th largest economy, and Silicon Beach is a major tech hub bringing in billions in VC funding each year.

ESSAY ANALYSIS

Over the last few years, UCLA Anderson has amended its required essays with ever-slimmer word counts, challenging applicants to be as direct and incisive as possible. This year it makes the bold move by wiping the slate clean and replacing its slate of essays with a singular question.



NEW REQUIRED ESSAY. How have events of the past year influenced the impact you would like to make in your community, career, or both? (250 words max)

We welcome reflection on any events that influenced you in your personal or professional lives, or in society in general, and look forward to learning about specific ways you want to leave your mark.

Before you sit down to write, take a big step back to consider the multitude of seismic events from the past year – including, but not limited to, economic instability, political polarization, racial justice protests, global pandemic – all of which are triggering unprecedented level of uncertainty and change worldwide. Rather than referencing several events on a superficial level, pick one that allows you to convey the kind of leader you are and hope to become. As you sift through the possibilities, the single most important action you can take is to spend significant time on self-reflection.

Note that Anderson isn't just asking about how you've been influenced by the past year's events, but how the "impact you would like to make" has been influenced (and, in the supporting subtext, a desire to learn "about specific ways you want to leave your mark"). What you choose to cite is less important than why you're citing it: how did it influence your thought process, mindset, next steps, aspirations?

This is a great opportunity to reveal your values, what you care about, and how recent and current circumstances motivate you to drive change in a way that serves a greater purpose. How did this incident shape your drive, your motivation, and your vision of the world? You must be able to convincingly connect the dots from where you've been and where you're

going, within the context of how the event of the past year have impacted your course.

One caution is to keep your audience in mind. This is a business school admissions essay after all, and your words are directed to Anderson's admissions committee. Know that UCLA Anderson defines its community by three core qualities: share success, think fearlessly and drive change. There is a lot of opportunity to exemplify one or more of those qualities as you consider your response. Anderson's motto, "Think in the Next," speaks to a penchant for bold thinkers who are unafraid to chart new pathways and effect change. Show some humility in thinking about leadership; Anderson's is a student-driven community where the notion of 'ambitious yet humble' is highly prized.

As you reflect on initial drafts, consider: What meaning can be discerned from your story and what does it say about you? Have a trusted friend, coach or colleague read your essay. If they can't see you in the story or feel an emotional resonance, then try again until it comes through.

Speaking of emotional resonance, don't let the need for brevity rob your responses of feeling. Remember to SHOW them the impact vs. simply telling them. One of the biggest mistakes I've seen is showing a lack of enthusiasm. If your tone doesn't convey excitement or energy, it won't stand out from the throngs of ambitious, excellence-driven wunderkinds. Same if you haven't taken the time to do substantive introspection and your essays lack meaningful insight or self-awareness. Remember, you want to leave the reviewer with a desire to meet you in person to learn more.

DEADLINES & DATES

	APPLICATION DEADLINE	DECISION NOTIFICATION
1st Deadline	1 October 2020	18 December 2020
2nd Deadline	8 January 2021	26 March 2021
3rd Deadline	16 April 2021	21 May 2021

**The best time to
apply is when you're
ready.**

Caroline Diarte Edwards,
Co-Founder & Director of Fortuna Admissions

LET'S GET YOU IN.

Fortuna Admissions is a dream team of former MBA Admissions Directors and Officers from the top-tier business schools, including Wharton, INSEAD, Harvard Business School, Stanford GSB, Kellogg, LBS, Chicago Booth, Columbia, NYU Stern, IE, Duke Fuqua, UCLA Anderson, Yale SOM, Cornell Johnson and Berkeley Haas.

As industry experts, we regularly provide commentary and analysis about b-school admissions for major media around the world. To read our full range of advice visit: FortunaAdmissions.com

With our unparalleled collective expertise, we are able to coach you to develop a clear vision of your goals for business school and beyond. We work closely with you throughout the application process and provide expert guidance at every stage to maximize your chances of admission to a top school.

Our free consultations are consistently rated as the best in the industry. To learn more about Fortuna and assess your chances of admission, reserve yours at: FortunaAdmissions.com

